PROJECT SCROLL

# The Valley Kitchen

Recipes and household hints from the old cookbooks and newspapers of the St. Joseph River valley, printed word for word, with a note on making each one today.

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RECIPE · THREE RIVERS, MICHIGAN (ST. JOSEPH COUNTY), ABOUT 1896

## Celery Soup

> *Cut a bunch of celery and boil it thoroughly one hour. Add one quart of chicken broth, one cup sweet cream, pepper and salt.*

**Making it today.** Chop one head of celery and simmer it in a little salted water about an hour, until very soft (blend it smooth if you like). Add 4 cups chicken broth and 1 cup heavy or light cream, heat through without boiling, and season with salt and pepper.

From The Three Rivers Cook Book (reprint, with supplement), King's Daughters Society, Mrs. S. A. Walton.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Blue Grass Corn Pudding

> *For quart pan size: 12 ears corn; split corn down the grain (do not cut grains off cobb), then scrape; mix well with corn; 3 eggs well beaten, 1 lump butter, size egg, ½ teaspoonful of salt, just a little sugar, pepper to taste. 1 pint sweet milk. In medium hot oven, cook 25 minutes (till top of pudding is well brown). Serve as vegetable.*

**Making it today.** Score down each row of kernels on 12 ears of fresh sweet corn and scrape the pulp and milk into a bowl (about 4 cups). Stir in 3 beaten eggs, 4 tablespoons melted butter ('size of an egg' is about 1/4 cup), 1/2 teaspoon salt, a pinch of sugar, pepper and 2 cups whole milk. Bake in a buttered 1 1/2- to 2-quart dish at 375°F for 25 to 35 minutes, until set and well browned on top.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Roger Hanson Peters.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Planked White Fish

> *Take a hardwood plank of well seasoned maple or oak about 1 1-2 feet long, 10 or 12 inches wide and 2 inches thick. Pour boiling water over it before using, until heated through. Split the fish open, bone, season well, lay upon the plank and bake. If the fish seems too dry, slices of salt pork may be placed upon the fish while baking. The fish should be served on the plank which may be garnished with rock salt or sprigs of parsley. The plank gives a peculiar delicious flavor which distinguishes it from fish baked in the ordinary way. Before serving cover fish with maitre de hotel sauce.*

**Making it today.** Soak an untreated oak, maple or cedar cooking plank, then heat it in a 400°F oven. Lay a boned, butterflied whitefish skin-side down on the hot plank, season, top with a few strips of bacon if you like, and bake at 400°F for 15 to 20 minutes, until it flakes. Serve on the plank with lemon-parsley butter (maître d'hôtel butter).

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Mrs. Chas. A. Peck.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Rabbit Fricassee

> *Joint 2 carefully dressed rabbits, and place in a large dish of cold water with a handful of salt. Soak for 2 hours. Remove and rinse with fresh water, cover the bottom of a kettle with strips of salt pork (about ¼ of a lb.). When it is fried brown, slice on it a large onion and toss till light brown. Now add the jointed rabbit and stir till all are seared over; then add 1 qt. of boiling water, 1 tsp. salt and a pinch of red pepper. Place on the back of the range and simmer gently for 2 hours, or until perfectly tender. ... This is an excellent and economical dish in early winter when rabbits are in good condition.*

**Making it today.** Brine two cut-up rabbits in salted water for 2 hours, then rinse. Brown 1/4 lb diced salt pork or bacon in a Dutch oven, add a sliced onion until golden, then sear the rabbit. Add 4 cups boiling water, 1 teaspoon salt and a pinch of cayenne, cover and simmer on low heat 1 1/2 to 2 hours until tender; thicken the broth for gravy and serve with currant jelly.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Florence S. Wattles.

RECIPE · THREE RIVERS, MICHIGAN (ST. JOSEPH COUNTY), ABOUT 1896

## Apple Fritters

> *Two egg, well beaten, one-half teaspoon salt, one cup milk, two and one-half cups of flour, two tablespoons of sugar, two tablespoons baking powder, four apples thickly sliced; flavor with vanilla. Fry as you would fried cakes and serve hot with maple syrup or a lemon sauce.*

**Making it today.** Whisk 2 eggs, 1 cup milk, 2 tablespoons sugar, 1/2 teaspoon salt and a little vanilla; stir in 2 1/2 cups flour and 1 tablespoon baking powder (the original's 2 tablespoons is a lot for modern double-acting powder). Fold in 4 sliced apples, drop by spoonfuls into oil heated to 350–365°F, and fry until golden, 3–4 minutes. Serve hot with real maple syrup.

From The Three Rivers Cook Book (reprint, with supplement), King's Daughters Society, Mrs. F. H. Case.

RECIPE · THREE RIVERS, MICHIGAN (ST. JOSEPH COUNTY), ABOUT 1896

## Marlborough Pie

> *Pare tart, mellow apples, quarter and take out seeds, stew in a little water until soft enough to put through a sieve. To twelve tablespoons of apple put same of sugar, six spoons melted butter, one-half pint of milk, the juice and rind of one lemon, some nutmeg. Bake in one crust, use whipped cream if you like it.*

**Making it today.** Cook tart apples into a smooth sauce; measure 3/4 cup and mix with 3/4 cup sugar, 6 tablespoons melted butter, 1 cup milk, the zest and juice of a lemon and a grating of nutmeg (most cooks today also add 2–3 beaten eggs so the custard sets). Pour into an unbaked 9-inch crust and bake at 425°F for 10 minutes, then 350°F for 35–45 minutes until set. Top with whipped cream.

From The Three Rivers Cook Book (reprint, with supplement), King's Daughters Society, Mrs. C. H. Harris.

RECIPE · THREE RIVERS, MICHIGAN (ST. JOSEPH COUNTY), ABOUT 1896

## Cream Peach Pie

> *Line a pie tin with rich paste, peel, halve and seed peaches enough to fill the pan, mix two tablespoons of flour with one cup of sugar and sprinkle over the peaches, fill the pan with thick sweet cream and bake until done. Canned peaches may be used or apples cut in small pieces.*

**Making it today.** Fit a 9-inch pie plate with pastry and fill it with peeled peach halves, cut side up. Mix 1 cup sugar with 2 tablespoons flour, sprinkle over the fruit, and pour in about 1 cup heavy cream. Bake at 425°F for 15 minutes, then 350°F for 30–40 minutes, until the cream is set and lightly browned; cool before slicing.

From The Three Rivers Cook Book (reprint, with supplement), King's Daughters Society, Emma Masser.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Boiled Huckleberry Pudding

> *Measure ¾ pt. of sifted flour; add to it 1 teaspoon baking powder, ½ salt spoon of salt. Sift thoroughly together. Stir a well beaten egg into ½ pt. milk, and stir this gradually into flour, making a smooth batter. Then stir in 1½ cups of berries; turn into a buttered mould, and steam, in enough boiling water to partly cover the mould, for 1 hour. Serve with hard or liquid sauce.*

**Making it today.** Sift 1 1/2 cups flour with 1 teaspoon baking powder and 1/8 teaspoon salt; beat 1 egg into 1 cup milk and stir in to make a smooth batter, then fold in 1 1/2 cups huckleberries or wild blueberries. Pour into a buttered 1 1/2-quart pudding mold or heatproof bowl, cover tightly with foil, and steam on a rack in a covered pot of simmering water (halfway up the mold) for 1 hour. Serve warm with hard sauce or a sweet sauce.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Mrs. A. K. Edwards.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Pickle Peaches

> *5 lbs. of peaches, 3 lbs. granulated sugar, ½ pint vinegar, 1 oz. cassia buds. Stick cassia buds into peaches. Make a good syrup with sugar and vinegar. Put fruit into hot syrup, and cook until tender. Place peaches in jar and pour over them the hot syrup.*

**Making it today.** Peel 5 lb small, firm peaches and stud each with a few cassia buds (or whole cloves, or add cinnamon sticks to the syrup). Boil 6 cups sugar with 1 cup vinegar to a syrup, simmer the peaches in it until just tender, pack into hot jars and cover with the boiling syrup. Store in the refrigerator, or follow current USDA home-canning guidance and process in a water bath.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Florence Myers.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Grape Juice

> *10 lbs. Concord grapes, 2 qts. water. Put on stove, and cook until grapes burst open, then put in cheese cloth bags; let drain, and squeeze a little. Add to juice 2 coffeecups of sugar, and let boil 5 minutes; or until sugar is all dissolved. Put up in Mason cans.*

**Making it today.** Simmer 10 lb stemmed Concord grapes with 8 cups water until the skins burst, about 10 minutes, then strain through a cheesecloth-lined colander or jelly bag, pressing lightly. Stir in about 2 cups sugar, boil 5 minutes, and pour into clean jars; refrigerate, freeze, or water-bath can following current USDA guidance.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Helen B. Pattison.

RECIPE · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Maple Creams

> *Cook 2 cups of pure maple syrup until a soft ball may be formed when dropped into cold water. Then add ¾ cup of sweet cream, and cook again till a soft ball is formed. Pour on marble slab, and proceed as with the fondant. Instead of mixing with the hands, it is better to cut into squares. Nuts may be stirred in with the wooden spatula.*

**Making it today.** Boil 2 cups pure maple syrup to the soft-ball stage (235–240°F), stir in 3/4 cup heavy cream, and boil again to 235–240°F. Pour onto a buttered marble slab or baking sheet, let cool slightly, then work it with a wooden spatula until creamy and thick; stir in chopped nuts and cut into squares.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church, Gene Siddall.

RECIPE · ELKHART, INDIANA, ABOUT 1900

## Popcorn Candy

> *Four quarts popped corn, one cup molasses; put the molasses in an iron kettle and let it boil till it candies, then put in a lump of butter the size of half an egg, stir in the corn till well mixed; pour out in a buttered dripping pan and flatten out; when cold enough cut in square cakes and wrap in paraffine paper.*

**Making it today.** Boil 1 cup molasses in a heavy pot to the hard-ball/soft-crack stage (about 260–270°F), stir in 2 tablespoons butter, then quickly toss in 4 quarts (16 cups) popped corn until coated. Press into a buttered sheet pan, let cool until firm, cut into squares and wrap in waxed paper.

From Dr. Miles' Candy Book (Dr. Miles Medical Co. advertising booklet).

RECIPE · SOUTH BEND, INDIANA, 1917

## Apple Butter With Cider

> *It usually takes about equal quantities of sweet cider and peeled and sliced apples to make butter the right consistency. In other words, two gallons of sweet cider should be boiled down to one gallon, and two gallons of peeled and sliced apples should be added to it either uncooked or as apple sauce. Two of the essentials of making good apple butter are long, slow cooking (four to six hours) and constant stirring. If sugar is used, it should be added after the cooking of cider and apples is about two-thirds done. ... Apple butter is spiced according to taste, about a half teaspoonful each of ground cinnamon, cloves and allspice being used for each gallon.*

**Making it today.** Boil 2 quarts fresh sweet cider down to 1 quart, add 2 quarts peeled, sliced apples, and cook low and slow, stirring often, for several hours (a slow cooker or a 300°F oven with the lid ajar works well) until thick enough that it doesn't separate. Add about 1/2 to 1 cup sugar two-thirds of the way through if you like, and a pinch each of cinnamon, cloves and allspice at the end. Refrigerate, or can following current USDA guidance.

From South Bend News-Times ("Canning Lesson" column).

HOUSEHOLD HINT · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## Doughnuts and silver: two kitchen hints

> *A spoonful of vinegar in a kettle of hot lard will prevent doughnuts from absorbing fat. ... A little dry salt will remove egg stains from silver.*

**Making it today.** The vinegar trick is still passed around by doughnut makers. Keep the frying fat at 350–375°F; that matters most for doughnuts that aren't greasy. For silver, rub egg-tarnish spots with a pinch of salt on a damp cloth, then wash and dry.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church ("Household Hints").

HOUSEHOLD HINT · KALAMAZOO, MICHIGAN, 1906

## To take rust out of linen

> *Rust may be removed from linen by being covered with salt, wet thoroughly with lemon juice, and laid in the hot sun for several hours.*

**Making it today.** This still works on white cotton and linen: sprinkle the spot with salt, soak it with fresh lemon juice, and leave it in strong sunlight for a few hours, then launder. Test colored fabric first, because lemon and sun can bleach it.

From New Crumbs of Comfort: A Cook Book, compiled by the Ladies of St. Luke's Church ("Household Hints").

HOUSEHOLD HINT · NAPPANEE, INDIANA (ELKHART COUNTY), 1921

## Taking care of the ice chest

> *Keep the ice chest clean; wipe up anything spilled in it and, when necessary, wash it out with hot water, using two tablespoonfuls of washing soda to each gallon of water; rinse and dry thoroughly. ... Keep the ice compartment well filled. This is economy in the long run. Do not cover the ice with ice blankets, newspapers, or cloth. These prevent the ice melting, but make the ice chest less cool.*

**Making it today.** The same idea works for a modern refrigerator or a camp cooler: keep it clean and full, and open the door as little as you can. A few tablespoons of baking soda in warm water is a gentler way to wash it out than washing soda.

From Nappanee Advance-News.